

"The Clockmaker's Gift"

In a quiet village nestled between misty hills, there lived an old clockmaker named Elias. His shop was a curious place—filled with ticking, whirring, and chiming from hundreds of clocks, each with its own personality. But Elias had one rule: he never sold his clocks. He gave them away.

Every clock he crafted was meant for someone specific. He'd study people quietly, noting their rhythms, their silences, their laughter. Then, late at night, he'd build a clock that matched their soul. A shy girl received a clock that whispered the time in soft tones. A baker got one that chimed like rising dough. A lonely widower received a clock that played his wife's favorite lullaby at dusk.

One day, a traveler arrived in the village—young, restless, and full of questions. He asked Elias why he gave away his creations.

Elias smiled and said, "Time is the only thing we truly share. I just help people hear it in a way that feels like home."

The traveler stayed for a week, then a month, then a year. When Elias passed away quietly one morning, the village found a final clock ticking in his shop. It had no hands, no numbers—just a gentle heartbeat.

The traveler took over the shop, and the clocks kept ticking.